Mathematics & Statistics | Lancaster University

Behind the publication process

Rebecca Killick(r.killick@lancs.ac.uk)
SAWAF 2021

Overview

- Why publish?
- Deciding where to publish
- What happens when you click submit?
- How to improve your chances of success
- Discussion

About Me

Mathematics & Statistics | Lancaster University

- Associate Professor of Statistics at Lancaster University, UK
- Head of the Lancaster University Women's Network
- Editor-in-Chief of the Journal of Statistical Software
- Associate Editor of Biometrics
- Associate Editor of Data Science in Science (new journal)

Why publish?

- To share your work with the field
- To create scholarly discussion
- To increase your reputation
- To get promoted

Why publish?

- To share your work with the field
- To create scholarly discussion
- To increase your reputation
- To get promoted



- Because our research contracts say we need to

Deciding where to publish

- All subjects have journal rankings

https://www.scimagojr.com/journalrank.php

- Don’t just go by rankings, talk to others about which journals they respect/read
- Look at where similar papers in your field have been published
- Ask colleagues for advice on where to submit
- Don’t just aim to the top journal, aim where you think it will fit
- Look at the list of associate editors, is there anyone from your field listed

When you click submit

1. Editorial office check the submission . . . asked to resubmit
2. Editor-in-chief checks remit and fit . . . reject

When you click submit

1. Editorial office check the submission . . . asked to resubmit
2. Editor-in-chief checks remit and fit . . . reject
3. Associate Editor (usually broad subject specialist) assigned . . . reject

When you click submit

1. Editorial office check the submission . . . asked to resubmit
2. Editor-in-chief checks remit and fit . . . reject
3. Associate Editor (usually broad subject specialist) assigned . . . reject
4. Reviewers asked to review
5. Reviewers agree
6. Reviewers provide a review

When you click submit

1. Editorial office check the submission . . . asked to resubmit
2. Editor-in-chief checks remit and fit . . . reject
3. Associate Editor (usually broad subject specialist) assigned . . . reject
4. Reviewers asked to review
5. Reviewers agree
6. Reviewers provide a review
7. Associate Editor considers reviews and recommends a decision
8. Editor-in-chief considers reviews and editors recommendation and makes a decision . . . reject

When you click submit

Mathematics & Statistics | Lancaster University

1. Editorial office check the submission . . . asked to resubmit
2. Editor-in-chief checks remit and fit . . . reject
3. Associate Editor (usually broad subject specialist) assigned . . . reject
4. Reviewers asked to review
5. Reviewers agree
6. Reviewers provide a review
7. Associate Editor considers reviews and recommends a decision
8. Editor-in-chief considers reviews and editors recommendation and makes a decision . . . reject
9. Invited to revise paper based on reviewers comments
10. Authors submit a revision and rebuttal letter

When you click submit

4. Reviewers asked to review
5. Reviewers agree
6. Reviewers provide a review

When you click submit

4. Reviewers asked to review
5. Reviewers agree
6. Reviewers provide a review
7. Associate Editor considers reviews and recommends a decision
8. Editor-in-chief considers reviews and editors recommendation and makes a decision . . . reject

When you click submit

4. Reviewers asked to review
5. Reviewers agree
6. Reviewers provide a review
7. Associate Editor considers reviews and recommends a decision
8. Editor-in-chief considers reviews and editors recommendation and makes a decision . . . reject
9. Paper accepted

When you click submit

4. Reviewers asked to review
5. Reviewers agree
6. Reviewers provide a review
7. Associate Editor considers reviews and recommends a decision
8. Editor-in-chief considers reviews and editors recommendation and makes a decision . . . reject
9. Paper accepted
10. Paper passes to post-processing
11. Editorial office formats the paper
12. Authors check the formatted paper
13. Paper queued for publishing in a future issue
14. Paper (finally!) published

Improve success rate

- Pass your paper to trusted colleagues to read before submitting
  - Act on their feedback!
- Leave the paper for a week or two and come back to it with fresh eyes
- Try to read your paper like a reviewer - look for the holes
- Try to think about what could make your paper better
  - Then think about whether it is worth doing it!
- Get to know discipline norms on the importance of cover letters

Improve success rate

- Read the journal remit and think if it is an appropriate outlet
- Read recent papers in the journal and think whether your work fits the style
- If you know any of the editors or people who have published there before, ask them if they think your paper would be a good fit
- Read the instructions for authors . . . and follow them
- Follow page limits
- Include everything the journal asks you to

Discussion

Over to you.